

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	The meaning and significance of paintings and drawings within Christianity with reference to two specific pieces and Catechism of the Catholic Church 2502–2503: the way these are used to express belief by the artist and those who observe the art, and the divergent ways in which paintings and drawings may be used in church and other settings.
4.2	The divergent meaning, significance and purpose of icons within Christianity: specific reference to the use of icons within Orthodox Christianity and in denominations that may reject their use; the way icons are used to express belief and as a focus for devotion, and the divergent ways in which they may be used in church and other settings.
4.3	The meaning and significance of sculpture for Christians: the way these are used to express belief by the artist and those who observe the art, the way these are used to express belief with reference to Catechism of the Catholic Church 2501; the divergent ways in which sculptures and statues may be used in church and other settings, for example in Roman Catholic and Anglican churches.
4.4	The purpose and use of symbolism and imagery in religious art: the Cross, including reference to Ephesians 2:10–19, fish, and symbols of the four evangelists; the way this symbolism is used to express belief, and the divergent ways in which they may be used in church and other settings.
4.5	The meaning and significance of drama: mystery plays, passion plays. The way drama is used to express belief and events, including, for example Matthew 26–28, and the divergent ways in which drama may be used in church and other settings.
4.6	The purpose of literature in Christian life: fiction, non-fiction and poetry, including examples from the writings of CS Lewis such as <i>The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe</i> and <i>The Great Divorce</i> ; the way different types of literature are used to express belief, and the divergent ways in which they may be used in church and other settings.
4.7	The nature and use of traditional styles of music in worship: hymns, psalms and worship songs; the way traditional styles of music are used to express belief, including examples such as Gregorian Chant and reference to Musicum Sacrum; the divergent ways in which they may be used in church and other settings, when each might be used and why.
4.8	The nature and use of contemporary music in worship: hymns and worship songs; the way contemporary music is used to express belief, including examples such as the work of Graham Kendrick and the Casting Crowns, the divergent ways in which it may be used in Church and other settings, when it might be used and why.

Area of Study 1C – Islam

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Islam as a lived religion in the United Kingdom and throughout the world.

There are four sections: Beliefs and Teaching; Practices; Sources of Wisdom and Authority; Forms of Expression and Ways of Life.

Students will be expected to study Islam within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian.

Students should compare and contrast two areas of belief and practice within Christianity and Islam:

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.8)*
- The practice and significance of worship (2.3)*.

Students should recognise that Islam is one of the many religious traditions in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Hinduism, Judaism and Sikhism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content. Students should also recognise that within Islam there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Islam in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Sunni and Shi'a traditions.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs and practices to Muslims today should be explored throughout the four sections.

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The Six Beliefs of Islam: their nature, history and purpose, including Kitab al-iman 1:4; how they are understood and expressed in Sunni and Shi'a Muslim communities today; the importance of these principles for Muslims.
1.2	The Five Roots of 'Usul ad-Din in Shi'a Islam: Tawhid (oneness of Allah); 'Adl (Divine Justice); Nubuwwah (Prophethood); Imamah (Successors to Muhammad) and Mi'ad (The Day of Judgment and the Resurrection); the nature, history and purpose of the Five Roots with reference to their Qur'anic basis, including Surah 112 (the oneness of Allah); the importance of these principles for different Shi'a communities today, including Sevens and Twelvers.
1.3	The nature of Allah: how the characteristics of Allah are shown in the Qur'an and why they are important; Tawhid (oneness), including Surah 16:35-36, immanence, transcendence, omnipotence, beneficence, mercy, fairness and justice, Adalat in Shi'a Islam.
1.4	Risalah: the nature and importance of prophethood for Muslims, including Surah 2:136; what the roles of prophets teach Muslims, exemplified in the lives of Adam, Ibrahim, Isma'il, Musa, Dawud, Isa, and Muhammad.
1.5	Muslim holy books (Kutub) – the nature, history, significance and purpose of Muslim holy books with reference to: the Qur'an; the Tawrat (Torah), including Surah 5:43-48; the Zabur (Psalms), including Surah 4:163-171; the Injil (Gospel), including Surah 57:27; and the Sahifah (Scrolls). Divergent Muslim views about the importance of the holy books in their lives today.
1.6	Malaikah: the nature and importance of angels for Muslims; how angels Jibril, Isra'il and Mika'il are shown in the Qur'an, including Surah 32:11 and 2:97-98, and their significance for Muslims today.
1.7	al-Qadr: the nature and importance of Predestination for Muslims; how al-Qadr and human freedom relates to the Day of Judgement, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari 78:685; divergent understandings of predestination in Sunni and Shi'a Islam; the implications of belief in al-Qadr for Muslims today.
1.8*	Akhirah: Muslim teachings about life after death; the nature of judgement, paradise and hell; how they are shown in the Qur'an, including Surah 17:49-72; divergent ways in which Muslim teachings about life after death affect the life of a Muslim today.

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	Ten Obligatory Acts of Shi'a Islam: their nature, history and purpose of the Ten Obligatory Acts; the diversity of practice and importance of Ten Obligatory Acts for Shi'a Muslims today; their basis in the Qur'an, including reference to Surah 9:71–73; divergent understandings of these principles within Sunni Islam, including links with the Five Pillars.
2.2	Shahadah as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role and significance of Shahadah for Sunni and Shi'a Muslims, including reference to Surah 3:17–21; why reciting Shahadah is important for Muslims, and its place in Muslim practice today.
2.3*	Salah as one of the Five Pillars, including reference to Surah 15:98–99 and 29:45: the nature, history, significance and purpose of Salah for Sunni and Shi'a Muslims, including different ways of understanding them; how Salah is performed, including ablution, times, directions, movements and recitations, in the home and mosque and Jummah prayer.
2.4	Sawm as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role, significance and purpose of fasting during Ramadan, including Surah 2:183–185; those who are excused from fasting and why. The significance of the Night of Power: the nature, history and purpose of the Night of Power; why Laylat al-Qadr is important for Muslims today.
2.5	Zakah as one of the Five Pillars and Khums: the nature, role, significance and purpose of Zakah and Khums, including Surah 9:58–60 and 8:36–42; why Zakah is important for Sunni Muslims; why Khums is important for Shi'a Muslims; the benefits of receiving Zakah or Khums.
2.6	Hajj as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role, origins and significance of Hajj, including Surah 2:124–130 and 22:25–30; how Hajj is performed and why Hajj is important for Muslims; benefits and challenges of performing Hajj for Muslims.
2.7	Jihad: the origins, meaning and significance of Jihad in Islam; divergent understandings of Jihad within Islam, including the difference between lesser and greater Jihad; the conditions for declaration of lesser Jihad, including reference to Surah 2:190–194 and 22:39; the importance of Jihad in the life of Muslims.
2.8	The nature, origins, activities, meaning and significance of the celebration/commemoration of Id-ul-Adha, with reference to Surah 37:77–111, and Id-ul-Fitr in Sunni Islam, with reference to their place within Shi'a Islam; and Id-ul-Ghadeer, with reference to Hadith and the interpretation of Surah 5:3, and Ashura in Shi'a Islam, with reference to their place within Sunni Islam.

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	The Qur'an: the revelation and compilation of the Qur'an, including Surah 53:4–18; its significance and authority within Islam today; divergent ways in which the Qur'an is used in the daily life of a Muslim: informal and formal worship, in the home, in the mosque, as a source of teaching and guidance.
3.2	The Prophet Muhammad: events in the life of the Prophet, including teaching and authority; his call, work in Makkah and Madinah, the Hijrah; the significance of these events and the Prophet Muhammad for Muslims today, including Surah 48:26–29.
3.3	The Seal of the Prophets, Surah 33:36–47: Muhammad's role as 'seal of the Prophets'; the final prophet; fulfilling the teachings of all other prophets, and as a role model to Muslims today; the significance of Muhammad as seal of the prophets and a role model today.
3.4	The divergent understandings of the significance of the family of the Prophet Muhammad: Caliph/Imam Ali (Ahl-ul-Bayt) in Sunni and Shi'a Islam and interpretations of Surah 33:32–34; the family of the Prophet in Ismaili Islam; the implications for questions of authority and the origins of the split between Sunni and Shi'a Islam.
3.5	The development and structure of the Hadith as a record of the Sunnah of the Prophet Muhammad: the structure and compilation of the Hadith, including isnad and matn; divergent understandings of their authority and significance within Sunni and Shi'a Islam today, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari, Sahih Muslim, and the Four Books.
3.6	Shari'ah Law: how it is agreed upon and the use of analogy (qiyas) and consensus (ijma), including interpretations of Surah 4:115; its divergence of use by the main schools of Sunni and Shi'a Islam; specific examples showing links between the Qur'an, Hadith, and Shari'ah; divergent understandings of the role and significance of judges (qadis) and scholars (the 'ulema) as sources of authority: the establishment of judges and scholars; examples of their rulings; the significance of authority within Islam today.
3.7	The Imam in Shi'a Islam, including reference to the Hadith of the pond of Khumm: history, major teachings and actions, divergent understandings of their contribution to Islam in Sunni and Shi'a thought, the doctrine of Nass, the Hidden Imam; the inerrancy and intercession of imams; the significance of the Imam for different forms of Shi'a Islam today.
3.8	The imam in Sunni Islam: the origins, nature, role of the imam in Sunni Islam, including Sahih al-Bukhari 73:34–37; divergent understandings of their contribution to individual and community life in Sunni and Shi'a thought.